

THE CROSSROADS

Special Amrit Yatra Issue



'THE GREATEST YATRA IS THE JOURNEY TOWARDS ONE'S OWN SELF'

- SWAMI CHINMAYANANDA

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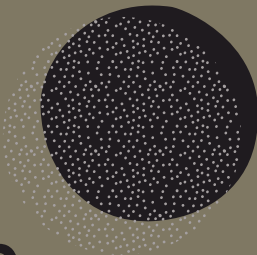
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EDITORIAL

-You can kill a man but never his ideal.

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The greatest of Bharat's most splendid accolades, its incomprehensible magnitude of indigenous diversity, all united together in the sweet essence of Sanatan Dharma, result in a magical land of ruthlessly disciplined leaders and gurus of the divine. This feat of our past grandeur is, however, taking a colonially structured nosedive into the oblivion of Indian history today. The friction and enmity among the many units of this very system of excellence has taken far too much of a toll on this nation. From the Mughals to the British, from the betrayers to the stragglers, they all had an array of weapons to shed blood and wreak havoc. But the most insidiously twisted action is definitely their brutal bludgeoning of our ideas, of what makes us one people, one identity, and one vision, or at least the assassination attempt on that ideal.

The 'ideal' in question, however, has not dissipated, but rather laboriously been buried underneath 'lesser' personal goals. The problem being that a great portion of our Bharatiyas have simply been forced out of integrating themselves and their goals with the nation's due to the suffering and strife passed down through generations. They have been forcefully disparaged due to ancestral trauma and the loss of vital community knowledge. This sinfully plagues the very essence of our goal as human beings; to consistently strive living up to higher ideals.

But in spite of all the suppression and agony, our culture's tenacity is unparalleled. From the latest Kumbh Mela stirring up a whopping 660 million devotees to the resurrection of the *Ram Mandir* in his *janma bhoomi*, Ayodhya. From each of our festivals blossoming with intent and meaning, to several notable world figures adopting fractions of our culture pertaining to *vasudhaiva kutumbakam* and *seva*, our true culture is devoid of anything meaningless. It wouldn't be amiss to state that our culture is far from a structural death.

So now we can outline the actual problem we face morphing from an ancient civilization to a modern nation. Our culture is not forgotten but rather neatly stowed away in the deepest, darkest crevices of our ignorance, for many of our Hindus are Hindus by birth but not by practice. The solution: A wake-up call. A clarion call to urge our countrymen to arise and awaken the infinite potential that innately resides within each one of them.

Needless to say, no one is coming to save us or bail us out of this grave of cultural neglect that several people who claim to be *Hindutva* still insist on digging. And in this great pit of neglect lies people writhing and struggling to get out by stepping on each other to hold on to flawed modern cultures like wokeism, secularism and - . Being an issue of great satirical irony, in fact, as they are only falling deeper into the clutches of social conformity, thereby eroding the very foundations of what we believe gives us our identity - Our shared culture, through diverse means, all through the expansive overseer, *Dharma*. Encapsulated in a sloka from the *Gita Panchamrit*:

||उद्धरेदात्मनात्मानं नात्मानमवसादयेत् |
आत्मैव ह्यात्मनो बन्धुरात्मैव रिपुरात्मनः||

A man must lift himself by himself, for the self is one's greatest friend and greatest enemy. Where the self lies in this spectrum hinges on every single thought and decision made by the individual. Simple decisions like applying tilak everyday or living a disciplined life through daily spiritual practices are conscious decisions that will drive our nation forward. Because sometimes the only way to move forward is to go back.

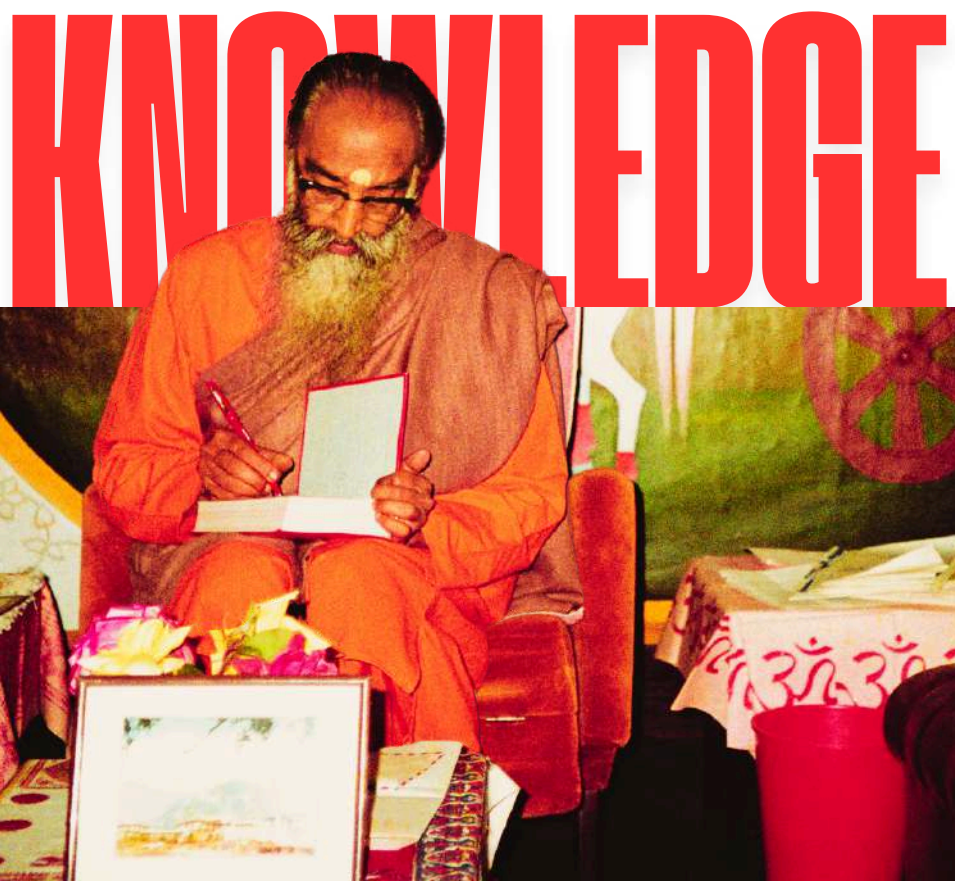
Our Gurudev, Swami Chinmayananda, is recognized as a great spiritual guru not because he invented something new. Gurudev is revered because he took what already existed—the fruit of our scriptures—and served it in an understandable and relatable way for the effective edification of our Bharatiyas. He identified this gap, went all around our nation and then all around the world catering to every age group, geographical location and demographic audience in its own unique way. Gurudev understood that the efficacy of a 'one size fits all' approach would be rendered redundant; almost laughable in a country such as ours. He was pivotal in rejuvenating our culture by tailoring its teachings to the devotees in question, leaving a spark in whosoever's heart he touched.

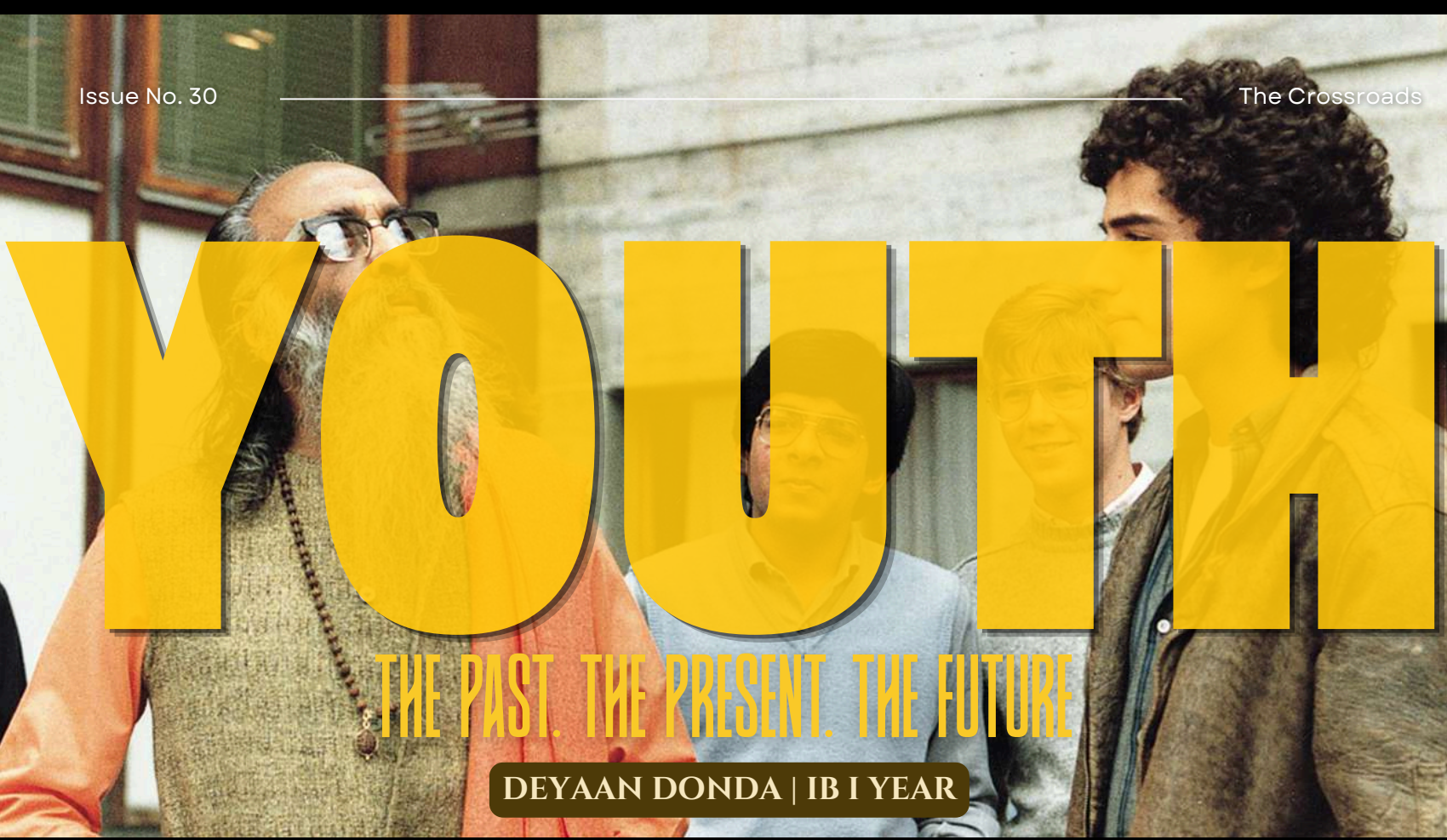


But in some, the spark persisted and soon it bloomed into a wildfire of devotion towards our motherland. One such catalyst working on threading together our citizens is the Chinmaya Amrit Yatra, which fosters impact at the grassroots level. 35,000 kilometers of it to be exact. And that is merely the beginning. The Yatra has just recently crossed 10,000 kilometers of our country, educating the youth, rekindling spirit with the old, and igniting patriotism in all. With 25,000 more kilometers remaining, the Yatra resides as the Chinmaya Mission's harbinger of the ideal nation.

But why is it happening? And why now? The Chinmaya Mission recently had its Amrit Mahotsav, celebrating 75 years of the mission. And as the main purpose of any celebration the mission walked away with several resolutions, one of them being 'devotion in action.' To be living, breathing Hindus rather than leading a cheerless existence being mere husks of what we advocate. The 295-day pilgrimage is set to culminate at the Bharat Mandapam in Delhi on 23 October 2026. The yatra itself carries Gurudev's articles, his spectacles, clothes and his statue, and is known as the 'temple on wheels.' There is also Gurudev's pointer with which he taught. It led to the famous saying, "I'm the pointer, not the pointed."

All these items matter not because of what they are or the material which they are made of, but because of the ideal they represent; for you can kill a man but never his ideal.





YOUTH

THE PAST. THE PRESENT. THE FUTURE

DEYAAN DONDA | IB I YEAR

When you think about a nation, the first thing that comes to your mind is the government. People working in large offices, making huge decisions, shaping the destiny of a nation. But these leaders and decision makers are just part of a larger society. A society that contains a set of the most important group of people, who can etch the nation's name in history forever. The youth. The future of the nation is not shaped in large offices by today's leaders, but in smaller places like schools, in random conversations, and in the thoughts of young minds.

We are always told that the youth are the future of the nation, that the young minds will influence the development of the nation, and thus must become a powerful leading force. But we were never told about the role of the youth in shaping the present. They are already influencing what's happening right now. And that's what makes the youth such a powerful force. At the same time, it's also what makes them a little dangerous.

The special thing about youth that no one else has is their ability to feel the situation instead of just thinking about it. Instead of sitting back and accepting things as they are, they act on them. They stand up and question every aspect of their life. This quality is extremely important for them to drive the nation as nothing would ever change if questions were never asked.

If we take a look at the history of any nation, the changing events did not just 'happen'. They happened because of the young minds who decided to speak up against the wrong and fight for the right. This mindset helped shape the present of the nation. This mindset is seen even today. The only difference is that now, with social media, everything spreads faster. One idea, one video, one opinion, can reach thousands of people in mere minutes. This is how, such a mindset can bring major changes to the course of history, from the young revolutionaries to the upcoming generations.

In this era, students and teenagers can be seen talking and writing about topics like equality, justice and climate change. But these restless minds cannot just let these ideas stay on paper. Students of schools and colleges are taking up initiatives to turn these ideas into movements. Of which many are backed by powerful institutions, supporting the evolution and growth of the youth community.

But here's the thing: not everything is as powerful as it looks online. Posting videos, sharing opinions, or following trends might feel like action. But in reality, it does not always have an impact. It is the youth who stand up and volunteer, who help others, who actually try to fix problems in their own communities. They are the ones making a difference, often with no attention.



Open-mindedness helps young minds adapt quickly and provide the most efficient outcomes. For example, the adaptation to technology has helped the youth better explore different aspects of life. They have grown up with technology, with change, and thus with constantly evolving ideas. So they are not afraid to try something different. That is why you see so many young people starting businesses, creating content, or thinking in ways that feel completely new. They are not just following the system, they are trying to change it.



This is the bustling force and power of the upcoming generations. But with great power comes great responsibility. Such a powerful leading force without direction is useless. It is very easy today to believe something without really understanding it. Information is everywhere, but not all of it is true. And when strong emotions mix with partial knowledge, things can get messy. People get divided, arguments happen, and sometimes decisions are made without thinking things through.

It is not that youth are bad, it is just that they have a lot of power without always having direction. And power without direction can go anywhere, or even worse - nowhere. What really matters is awareness. Asking questions is good but taking the time to understand them is even better. Having opinions is important but knowing why you have them matters more.

At the same time, being young isn't easy either. There is pressure to do well, to figure out your life and to not mess up. Social media makes it worse because it constantly feels like everyone else is doing better. It is confusing, and sometimes overwhelming. But even with all that, the youth keep going. They try, they fail, they learn, and they try again. And that resilience, that ability to keep moving forward is what makes them so important to a nation.

In the end, youth is not perfect. They are still figuring things out. But maybe that is exactly why they matter so much. They question things, they challenge ideas, and they aren't afraid to imagine something better. And honestly, a country needs that. Because ignoring youth is not just underestimating the future, it is ignoring what is already changing the present.

"Youth are not useless, they are used less."



SPORTSWASHING

THE NEW GEOPOLITICS

SHAURYA BHARTIA | XII MGMT

The summer of 2023 changed football forever. It wasn't just the usual go-to of European transfers; it was something weird. Why? When Cristiano Ronaldo moved to Al-Nassr, many dismissed it as a career-ending move. But then came other big names: Neymar. Sadio Mané. Firmino. Maharez. Saint-Maximin. And then the Ballon d'Or favorite, Karim Benzema. These players were all at the peak of their careers. Suddenly, the Saudi Pro League wasn't just a retirement home, it was a glitch in the transfer market.

As a Liverpool fan, seeing club captain Jordan Henderson or Fabinho depart for the Middle East after a monstrous season felt odd. But to understand why this happened, we have to look past this season alone. We have to look at the real referee of global power: Geopolitics. This isn't just about football, it's about a concept called 'Sportswashing.'

Sportswashing is 'the practice of a nation, corporation, or individual using the prestige and emotional pull of sports to improve a tarnished reputation or distract from political controversy.' A simple definition. But not-so-simple impacts.

The logic behind this is very simple: it is much harder to criticize a country's human rights record or its lack of democratic freedom when you are cheering for a 90th-minute winner by a player they bought for your team or when you are cheering for the F1 races hosted in their country. Soon unintentionally, you become emotionally attached to the country.

Saudi Arabia has generated enormous amounts of money from selling oil, but has a poor reputation regarding human rights, women's rights, religious fundamentalism, and slavery. The government has been accused of supporting terrorism, bombing school buses full of children, and even killing U.S.-based journalists in their embassies. By spending billions on Cristiano Ronaldo, LIV Golf, and the 2034 World Cup, they are buying their way into a clean reputation, to distract us from these human rights records. This strategy creates a historical mirror, stretching from the 1936 Olympics in Nazi Germany to Saudi Arabia's hosting of the 2023 Club World Cup.



THE TRUTH

A TROPHY
CANNOT ERASE

In football we often talk about 'club takeovers,' but in reality, Western sports organisations like the PGA and debt-heavy football clubs are begging for Saudi capital to survive. By providing this rescue money Saudi Arabia isn't just buying a club or a tour, they are buying veto power over Western cultural institutions and into our subconscious mind.

To understand the Saudi ideology, we must talk about Vision 2030, the brainchild of Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman. This plan is centred around the Crown Prince's goal of turning his country into one that can survive – post the end of its petroeconomy. To do well, he needs us to buy into his vision, which is difficult when the world associates his regime with a brutal dictatorship similar to North Korea.

This isn't just about global PR, it is also about internal stability. Sixty-three percent of the Saudi population is under the age of 30. Providing them with hardcore sports, like F1 or the FIFA World Cup, offers a distraction to keep their minds off major issues like unemployment, tethering their interests to state-controlled sports instead. This is what Saudi wants their ideal youth to be like.

And this is not something which has been brought on by Saudi Arabia as a new project: it has been carried out by different countries for decades. This isn't just about global PR, it is also about internal stability. Sixty-three percent of the Saudi population is under the age of 30. Providing them with hardcore sports like F1 or the FIFA World Cup, offers an anchor to keep their minds off major issues like unemployment, tethering their interests to state-controlled sports instead.

This is what Saudi wants their ideal youth to be like. It is a strategic trade, "We give you the world's best entertainment; you give us political stability." And this is not something which has been brought on by Saudi as a new project: it has been carried out by different countries through decades:

-Benito Mussolini's Italy: used the 1934 FIFA World Cup to defend their fascist disciplinarian projects.

-1936 Berlin Olympics: Nazi Germany used the Games to project a facade of a peaceful, tolerant nation while internally accelerating the holocaust.

-1980 Moscow Olympics: The Soviet Union conducted the Games to showcase communist superiority and global influence right after their invasion of Afghanistan.

-2014 Sochi Winter Olympics: Russia spent a record \$50 billion to project national prestige, only to launch the annexation of Crimea just weeks after the closing ceremony.

-The 2014 Sochi Olympics, The 2022 FIFA World Cup, the list goes on.

-2022 FIFA World Cup: Qatar spent an estimated \$220 billion on infrastructure to distract nations from its treatment of migrant laborers.

-The 2026 FIFA World Cup: USA is showcasing a narrative of national unity, masking the reality of extreme political polarization, record-high baseless deportation rates and lack of due processes.



In 2017, just as the nation was warming up for the tenth season of IPL the Finance Bill was passed just as a "Money Bill," quietly merging 19 tribunals and making Aadhaar mandatory. By classifying this bill as a Money Bill, the government effectively bypassed the opposition of the Rajya Sabha, allowing widely controversial shifts such as removing caps on corporate political funding to pass with minimal public scrutiny while the public was obviously anchored to the pitch. This has the potential to make our government indebted to private organisations without us every knowing.

Fast forward to last week; as RCB faced SRH, a Special Session was convened to fast-track the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill and the Delimitation Bill. Aimed at putting into practice the 2023 Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam for the 2029 elections, the amendment sensationally fell short of the required two-thirds majority in the Lok Sabha. Upon closer inspection, I've realised that these controversial Special Sessions are scheduled to coincide precisely with these IPL matches. This ensures that while the attention of fans is glued on the final overs, the country can be presented with fundamental changes that have the potential to alter the very things that we stand for.

Ultimately, we must realize that every boundary shot and goal cheered for is a distraction. Whether in Riyadh or New Delhi, this is what we see everyday around us, yet fail to notice how every small move made right in front of our eyes, has a much bigger play to it on the geopolitical arena.



THE ALCHEMY OF ACTION

SANNVI BAGARIA | IB I YEAR

Every thought carries within it a silent battle, one that we cannot see. The mind constructs, resists, reflects, and sometimes, rarely simply understands, yet within this constant movement lies a struggle for clarity. The Chinmaya Mission, through the Amrit Yatra, seeks to bring the wisdom of the Gita Panchamrit to seekers across Bharat. The Gita Panchamrit is a collection of five carefully chosen shlokas that encapsulate the essence of the entire Bhagavad Gita into its most supreme teachings. These verses are offered as “nectar drops,” each one gradually transforming the seeker’s way of living by providing unparalleled clarity. This is a story of what unfolds when these drops are not merely caught, but consumed.

This is the story of Veer. An Ordinary.

Veer’s life had always been extremely functional. He attended his classes, finished tasks, and followed routines. Everything looked great on the outside, but internally, he was constantly unstable. Things lingered in his mind far longer than they deserved.

And as we all have our breaking points, Veer had his. He had been rejected by a company for an internship he’d desired immensely. The rejection email was short and impersonal; what followed was not. He stopped attending his classes, burying himself in isolation. His mind simply would not allow him to move forward.

He kept dancing to the same song: “Something is wrong with me.”

Some days later, Veer was sitting outside his home, bored of isolation and the lecture after lecture from his father. For the first time, he noticed that his thoughts were still running, but he was separate from them. This separation felt uncomfortable, but with it came clarity. One of the things his father had said to him earlier brushed through his mind.



उद्धरेदात्मनात्मानं नात्मानमवसादयेत् |
आत्मैव ह्यात्मनो बन्धुरात्मैव रिपुरात्मनः |

What had seemed like the end of the world now felt like a mere speed breaker. He realized that he is his own savior. There was no sudden transformation, only the realization of a responsibility— a responsibility that was his and his alone.

In the weeks that followed, Veer tried again. He applied for another opportunity. This time, he prepared more patiently. He studied, he practiced, and he ran himself ragged. But the pressure remained. Every action carried a silent condition: 'this has to work.'

This wasn't because he feared failure anymore, but because of a change in how he handled his expectations. When the second rejection came, he wasn't shattered, just regretful about the emotional exhaustion he had put himself through by tying his entire hardwork to the outcome. That evening, while pondering upon his mistakes and revisiting his preparation notes, something changed, not emotionally, but practically.

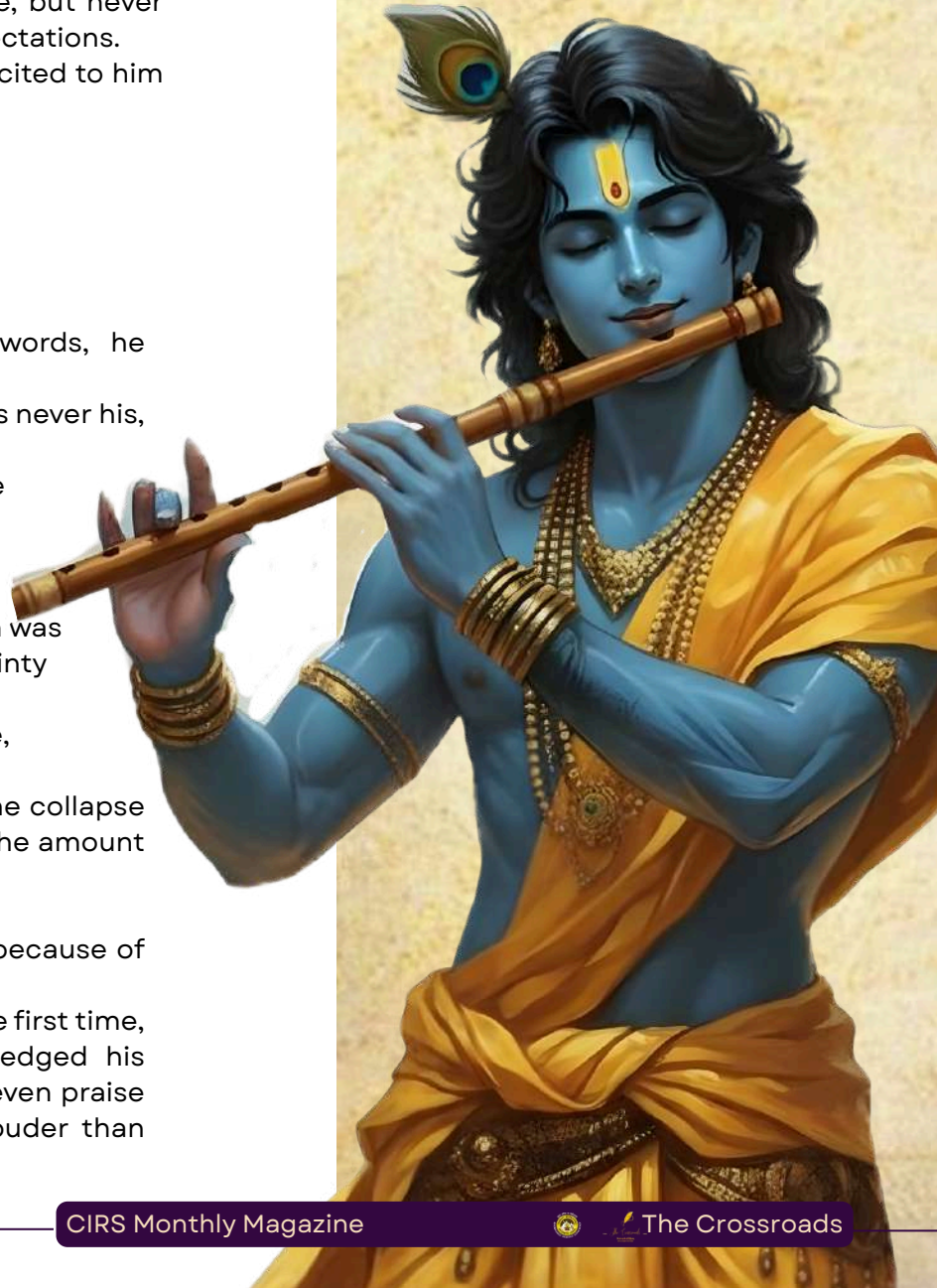
He understood that his preparation was intense, but never free. Every step he took was attached to his expectations. That is when the second verse his father had recited to him came into the picture.

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ।

This time, Veer didn't just understand the words, he understood his mistakes. He had been trying to control something that was never his, the results. Along the way, he had lost control over something that was actually his, every single time - his actions.

The shloka made him separate his actions from his anxiety and reminded him that his exhaustion was not from working hard, but from expecting certainty from something that could never be certain. What changed after this was not his success rate, but his behaviour under pressure. He still looked for opportunities, still prepared seriously, but the collapse after the outcomes reduced. He didn't change the amount of effort, only made it lighter.

The next shift that came in Veer's life was not because of his failures, it was because of the exact opposite. He joined a huge college project team and for the first time, his efforts were appreciated. People acknowledged his work. Veer had grown oblivious to the fact that even praise has its own gravity and sometimes, it binds louder than failure.



Notes of Healing

ISHAAN RAVISHANKAR | XII MGMT

Music is something most of us cherish, holding a special place in our lives. It speaks volumes about our personality, and offers insights into our very souls. So why is listening to music so gratifying? Why does it hold so much power over our minds, influencing even our emotions? What is it about random combinations of sounds put together that leave such a striking impression?

Music has the ability to bring us joy and comfort, it motivates us and helps us relax. It has the power to transport us back to our happy places, calming our, frenzied minds. On the other hand, this tricky tool has the ability to produce the most tense

and coldest of emotions. This effect is best seen in the blockbuster *Interstellar* (2014). The scores composed

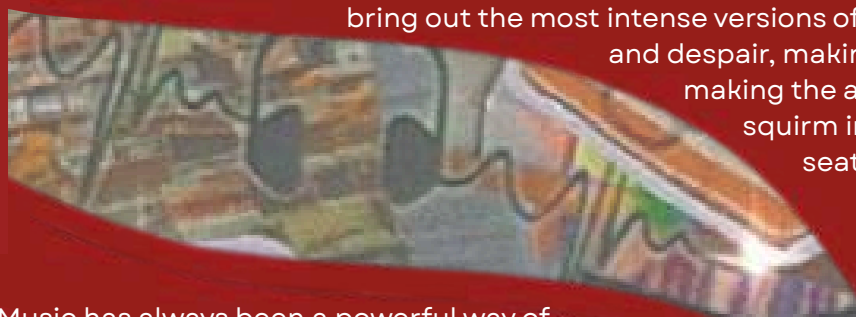
bring out the most intense versions of tension and despair, making the making the audience squirm in their seats.

Music has always been a powerful way of communicating. Music helps

provide social and cultural identities to people. Music has the power to unite, inspire, and change the experiences we undergo. For example, National anthems connect crowds at sporting events, sacred hymns build group identity in religious gatherings and the occasional neighbourhood band fosters collectiveness and teamwork.

Music psychology, a branch under the wide study of *Musiology*, is a field of study diving into the science of the dimensions displayed by music by searching through the human brain for answers on how humans perceive, respond and interact with music. It explores the relationship between human behaviour and emotion while composing music, playing instruments or even singing your heart out. It aims to understand how people experience music and how in turn music affects behavior. The study of music psychology also helps researchers understand the differences and effects of music in different cultures.

This application of musicology is very versatile, extending to various fields of study ranging from performance psychology - helping professional athletes train, to the use of music to enhance the concentration of surgeons, where music is played at specific tempos to enhance performance and maintain stability.



One of the most well-known uses of music psychology is Music Therapy, wherein music is used to cure ailments, both mental and physical. Researchers have determined that music can soothe upset people, motivate those in need of encouragement, and affect emotions in various other ways. Music therapists use this knowledge to prescribe certain music to help those with certain mental and cognitive health issues. For example, a music therapist working with a patient with post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) might recommend the use of classical music to help the patient remain calm, while upbeat music can thwart motion sickness and nausea.

This form of therapy has been tried and tested on countless occasions, producing results that stun medical professionals, abbreviating diseases once said to be incurable. It has proven to improve cognition for patients with conditions like Retrograde Amnesia, Dementia,

Alzheimer's and other autoimmune diseases with just some music that associates the patient with meaningful

memories. Music can help retain essential information despite the above diseases. 'Music

memory' is stored in the hippocampus, located in the centre of the brain. Therefore, music memories are less likely to be negatively impacted by age or disease. It also

demonstrates the effect of music on speech and language, curing stuttering and linguistic disorders. Because music is often an enjoyable activity, it can activate the release of endorphins, which creates a general feeling of well-being.



Music therapy can successfully reduce post-operative pain, physical tension and influence heart and breathing rates. Fast music tends to increase pulse rate and blood pressure. Slow music tends to decrease pulse rate and blood pressure, as well as breathing rate. This technique is used for patients posted in Intensive Care Units to support recovery.

Music has a profound influence on health, culture and society. Its power to sway us to its tunes is truly marvelous. Music psychology demonstrates that music is much more than entertainment by scientifically analysing the human brain and its responses to music. Its applications extend far beyond leisurely listening, helping professionals enhance focus, endurance and stability. Every tune transforms you, every rhythm changes you, and every melody modifies you.

The GEM of Life

JAYNA MOTWANI | VIII C

**Rubies shine effortlessly,
Diamonds put up a show.
Emeralds too are lovely,
But sapphires do strike a blow.**

**Gems may be pretty,
But priceless they are too.
Doesn't matter if they are itty-bitty,
Or the size of your shoe.**

**True gems are those, however,
People with hearts pure.
The shine of these falter never,
The magic of these forever allure.**



THE Atomic man of India

VIRAJ LAL | IB I YEAR

Today, many young Indians dream of going abroad to study and settle down. Nearly a century ago, a young Indian scientist did the exact opposite. At the age of twenty-nine, after having spent thirteen years in England studying at Cambridge - the centre of modern physics at the time - he returned to India for what was meant to be a short holiday. That short holiday became a lifelong commitment, one that reshaped India's scientific and technological future. That young Indian scientist was Dr Homi Jehangir Bhabha, the father of India's nuclear programme.

Around the time of independence, scientific research in India was unsupported and isolated. There were very few well-funded institutions, limited laboratories, and almost no coordinated effort to bring scientists together. Brilliant minds worked in isolation. For example, C. V. Raman, despite winning the Nobel Prize, conducted most of his research alone, with minimal institutional support.

Having witnessed firsthand the individual prowess harnessed by European institutions of research, Bhabha clearly understood this problem. He knew modern science could only advance through strong institutions rather than scattered individual brilliance. He acknowledged that without organised research centres, India's scientific talent would never reach its full potential.



Acting on this belief, Bhabha established the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR) in 1945. He believed that science could not grow through scattered efforts. He insisted that India had many capable scientists spread across the country who could achieve far more if brought together and given proper direction. Creating such an institution, he argued, was essential for national progress.

Bhabha also believed it was the responsibility of scientists like him to remain in their own country and build world-class centres of learning. This conviction shaped his lifelong commitment to institution-building and national service. During his years in Europe, Bhabha worked closely with some of the greatest physicists of the twentieth century, including Wolfgang Pauli, Paul Dirac, Niels Bohr, and Enrico Fermi. These interactions placed him at the heart of global developments in theoretical and nuclear physics and gave him first-hand experience of how world-class research environments functioned.

Bhabha's most enduring contribution was the creation of India's nuclear programme. He believed that nuclear science was not a luxury for a newly independent nation but a necessity. With the support of Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru, he played a central role in establishing the Atomic Energy Commission of India in 1948. This marked the formal beginning of India's atomic energy effort and reflected the immense trust placed in his scientific and strategic vision.



India's nuclear programme was guided by a long-term strategy known as the three-stage nuclear plan. Designed to suit India's limited uranium reserves and abundant thorium resources, the plan was both practical and forward-looking. In the first stage, reactors using natural uranium produced energy and were converted into plutonium through complex chemical reactions. In the second stage, this plutonium fuelled fast breeder reactors to generate more energy. In the final stage, thorium was converted into Uranium-233, enabling the long-term use of thorium as a sustainable fuel source. This approach aimed to ensure energy security and reduce dependence on imported resources.

Early research reactors played a crucial role in turning this vision into reality. Reactors like APSARA and CIRUS, built during Bhabha's lifetime, did not generate electricity but trained scientists and engineers, developed reactor technology, and built the confidence needed for commercial nuclear power generation. This groundwork later led to the establishment of the Tarapur Atomic Power Station in Maharashtra, India's first commercial nuclear power plant, which became operational in 1969, shortly after Bhabha's death. It reflected his belief that atomic energy was the most advanced and efficient solution for India's long-term industrial growth, beyond the limits of coal and hydropower.

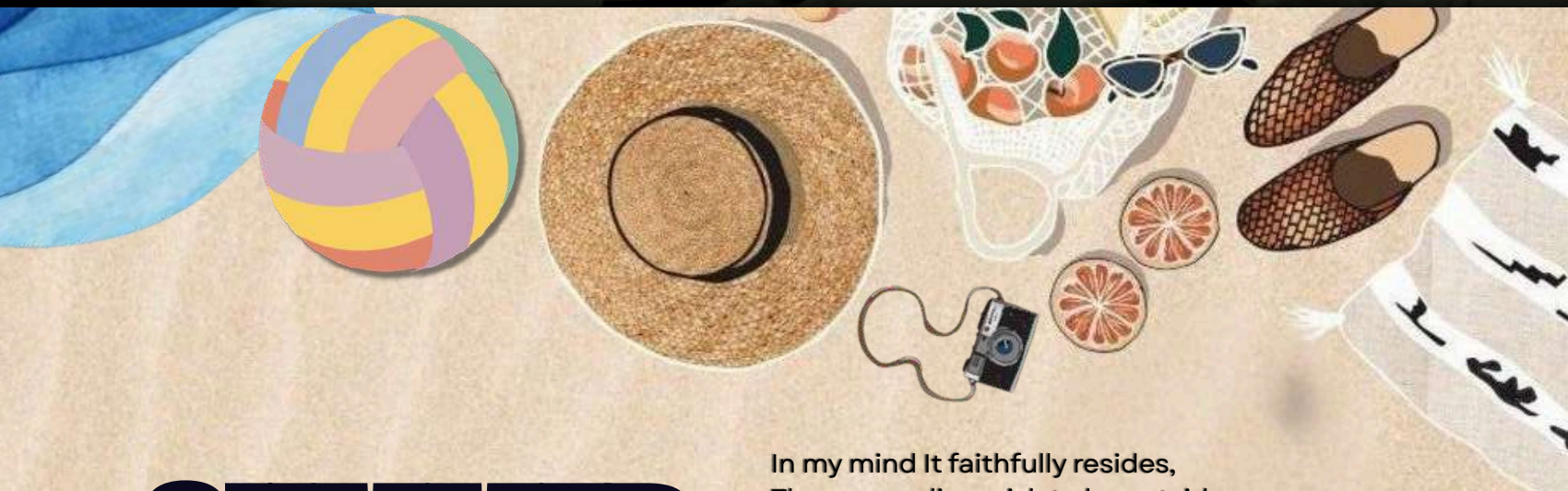


But Bhabha's vision extended beyond the peaceful uses of nuclear energy. In 1964, China conducted its first nuclear test, dramatically altering the power balance in Asia. The following year, Bhabha made a remarkable statement during a meeting with American officials "if India committed fully, it could produce a nuclear device within eighteen months—or in just six months with external assistance." This was not a request for help but a confident declaration of independence. Bhabha knew what India's scientists were capable of, and he wanted the world to know it too.



Dr Homi J. Bhabha was not only a brilliant physicist but also a visionary nation-builder. By choosing to return to India, create institutions, and plan decades ahead, he laid the foundation for the country's nuclear capabilities and contributed significantly to India's scientific self-reliance and strategic autonomy. His life remains a powerful reminder that true progress is shaped by those who choose responsibility over comfort and long-term vision over immediate success.

It is not my country's duty to push
me forward, but my duty to push
my country forward.



SUMMER SEASON

SHAUNAK KOLIPAKA | IB I YEAR

In my mind It faithfully resides,
The resounding wish to be outside.
Thus I brave the summer cries,
And embrace the fiery passion that lies deep inside.

The burning sun and its immense heat,
A cold glass of water is what I seek.
Long days and short nights,
A perfect weather to fly kites.

Walking on long beaches ,
Meeting waves of strong reaches.
The calm silence teaches,
That we should dream beyond our breaches.

In these sunlit days, where we find our niches,
We grow into the dreams that quietly reach us.



REBELLION OR CHOICE?

AASHI KEDIA | IB I YEAR I

Classrooms or kitchens. Textbooks or sports shoes. Tolerance or confrontation. That's just a tiny peek into the walls a girl unwillingly faces each day. Sounds mentally exhausting, doesn't it? They don't ask the world to make decisions for them. And they don't very well enjoy people pasting labels on them. So, when did their personal choices become everyone's business? Because when I look back, I don't see a world dripping with expectations from women, but a history where a choice was given to Maa Sita between the luxuries of the palace and 14 years of hardship in exile. To Radha, between a physical boon from Krishna or listening to his flute one last time, and Maa Lakshmi between the devas and the asuras.

Today, when a girl chooses the stage to debate over dance, takes something challenging over the "safe" subjects and chooses her mental peace over gossip of the society, some people out there still have the cheek to mock and question her decisions. Lounging on their dining tables and sofas, talking about a girl they barely know. When a boy makes a decision for himself it's planning, but when a girl decides for herself it's called rebellion. Families are proud of confident and smart daughters but they are careful about confident and smart decisions. It's weird, isn't it?

Our grandmothers tell us long tales about queens who walked beside kings as equals, fought wars with their children strapped to their backs, learned warfare at early ages, sat among ministers and scholars in courts, challenged narratives and their narrators and yet are expected to explain themselves again and again.

Surprisingly, women today aren't doing abnormal or extraordinary things, they are only doing what they always have been doing, pushing past storms they have forever been capable of controlling. They are busy getting back what was always theirs. Cricket is no longer just about the men in blue and the lady is no longer the only one who cooks after a long day. As of early 2026, over 1.02 lakh startups in India have at least 1 woman director or partner. India has the highest percentage of female STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics) graduates in the world at 43%. 44% of India's gamers are now women. 1 in 4 young women (under 25) in India have considered sports as a professional career. Women across Bharat are realizing that each one of them can be just like Sita - poised, thoughtful and righteous while being indomitable, fearless and fierce at the same time. Women who command boardrooms and respect from everyone, because their every action speaks of purpose and strength.



Today, all they ask from you is that, when they travel across cities for competitions, speak up what's right without lowering their voices, and contradict an invalid point in the classroom, you don't make a big deal of it, but silently appreciate it. Every decision about their career or interest does not necessarily need discussion. For it's not a communal decision, but a personal one. When we stop making things hard for women, life is easier for all of us. Let her be. Let her decide. Let the numbers speak, and for once, let the world not stand in her way.

Because we all know that when Sita Maa, Radha and Maa Lakshmi decided for themselves, they wrote legacies we are all a part of today.



I believe service is sacrificing one's own personal interests and fun for the sake of some higher, bigger and nobler goal. But today, it is reduced to just a certificate, a LinkedIn post or a college application.

I completed my CBSE 10th grade board examinations recently and after that we received a short one month break until the next session started. In that one month, I was introduced to a completely different subject which I never studied before. That subject was LIFE. I was not very sure about what subjects I wanted in the IBDP and my parents were really worried about me so they decided to take me to a CAREER COUNSELLOR.

I had a conversation with several counsellors and we discussed universities, subjects, career and most importantly, how to build a perfect CV. I noticed that all the counsellors spoke the same language. One element from this monotony that hit me hard was their definition of service.

They all spoke as if orphanages and temples were a joke. They said, "One day you should go and teach orphans in orphanages and get a certificate." I was completely against it. I replied to her respectfully, "Madam, in orphanages, there are teachers who teach them different subjects. And if I had to teach them something, I would not be able to do so in one day. I myself take time to grasp concepts. It is not possible in one day." The world has made orphanages a place to earn certificates. Do you think those young kids can learn concepts in one day? They will definitely forget it after two days. And daily, some or the other certificate collector would come there to teach them something, instead of willing to learn, they would become resistant to it. Do you think that they like it when rich people come there and forcefully serve them, making them feel homeless even if they aren't? Is this called service?

The next big service which is often spoken about is cleaning places. The rich and elite schools usually take their students to different places like slums, temples, parks or roads to clean it. Once, one of my friends was taken to a temple from school to clean it. He told me how excited he was before going there to clean that place. When he reached there, he saw that the temple was already clean. Everyday, annas and akkas would clean the whole temple in the morning. I wondered, in a year of 365 days, one day if they will go and act to clean the temple, how is that going to make an impact? In fact, I feel that we are disrespecting the workers who work hard every single day and clean different places. Is this service?

HAS SEVA BECOME A JOKE?

AARAV BHARTIA | IB I YEAR I

Service should have a long term impact on society and not just a method to get into good universities. Let us take the example of our own Chinmaya Mission. It is a non-profit organisation that works only for the welfare of the society. Numerous Acharyas and Swamijis, dedicate their whole life to bring a change in people, to transform their lives and make them spiritually, mentally and physically strong. They do not do it for any recognition or award. It is purely a selfless act. The Chinmaya Organisation for Rural Development constantly takes up initiatives to build long term foundations and programs for rural people, transforming generations of life. I believe that that is true service.

The word, 'service' or 'seva' has a deep value but we have made it a joke. Service is ideally meant to be selfless - without expecting anything in return. But, today's youth has made it the most selfish activity in the world. We are disrespecting not only the people who we target to get a certificate from but also those who actually selflessly sacrifice their time, money and sometimes even their lives for a higher cause. We, the youth of this country, should raise our voices against this kind of "service". Instead, we should actively take up real acts of service, real seva that will have a significant and positive impact on society.



वही हाथ

VIRAJ LAL | IB I YEAR

ADHYATMA AGARWAL | IB I YEAR

अब यहां न 'यूनियन जैक' फहराता है, न सड़क पर 'रेडकोट' की टोली है
नहीं गाते हम 'गॉड सेव द किंग', ना ही हमें साम्राज्य का कोई जोर है
झंडा बदला, गान बदला, पर हाथो का वो रंग ना गया
जो अपनों का खून बहता था, वो जहरीला ढांग ना गया
अब कत्ल के लिए किसी विदेशी का इंतज़ार नहीं होता
क्योंकि अपनों के वार जैसा, कोई गहरा वार नहीं होता

१३ अप्रैल उन्नीस सौ उन्नीस का वो दिन था
नए कपड़े गरम रोटियां, बच्चों के खेलने का वह दिन था
गुस्सा का अंश छोड़ो, आशा की किरण भरी थी
मगर सूर्यास्त तक उसी बाग में लाशों की ढेर भारी थी

एक द्वार, एक बाग, एक क्रूर फरमान
सोलह सौ गोलियाँ, और अपनों का ही निशान।
वही माटी जूतों तले, वही भगवान आँखों के पार
वही माँ का हाथ, जिसने खिलाया था कल प्यार।
अब न रहे वे हाथ, न ही रहा वो प्यार भरा संसार

किसी 'डायर' का वो आदेश ना था, ना किसी अंग्रेज़ ने वो रेखा खींची
वो हाथ हमारे अपने ही थे, जिन्होंने अपनों के ही लहू से मिट्टी देखी।
वही हाथ हैं, वही खेल पुराना, बस बदला हुआ है ये जमाना,
साम्राज्य को सिंहासन की चाह नहीं, उसे तो बस हमारा 'निशाना' है।

१९९० में आया एक संदेश
उसके पीछे एक भारतीय, पर बदल कर आया वेश
मक्सत उसका एक ही, करना है अब क्लेश
चाहे कुछ भी हो जाए तोड़ कर रहेगा देश
लाखों के संख्या में छोड़ गए कश्मीरी पंडित
भारत की परंपरा हो गई अब खंडित

अपनी ही धरती पर वो रातें-रात पराये हो गयीं,
बर्फ की चादर तले, हम अपने ही साए से खो गए
लिए हाथ में घर की छाबियाँ, वो रातें-रात बेसहारा हुईं,
यादों की पूंजी साथ रही, पर खुद की ही धरती पर आवारा हुई।

किताबों में दफ़न अतीत नहीं, ये रागों में दौड़ता ज़हर है
जड़ों को कोसने वालो! देखो, तुम्हारी ही वजह से आया ये केहर है।
दादी की उस पावन दुआ का, जब तुम मजाक उड़ाती हूँ,
दो पाल के झूठी वाह वाह में
तुम अपनी ही शान बेच आते हो
आज के 'डायर' को, किसी बन्दूक की दरकार नहीं
तुम्हारी अपनी नफ़रत से बड़ा, उसके पास कोई हथियार नहीं

२०० साल तक भारत की गुलामी का शासक आज भी चैन की नींद सोता है
क्योंकि तुम्हारी गुलामी का बीज, दोस्त! अब तुम्हारा अपना हाथ बोता है!

ROYAL
The Crossroads
MLA CLUB
DOGS OF INDIA



A Meeting of Lions...

A Message for History...

Visiting the Vivekananda Rock Memorial with Pujya Gundev Swami Chinmayarondaji's moorthi and padukas-s. was a unique experience.

With this, the Chinmaya Amrit Yatra, in their 75th year of Chinmaya Mission has arrived at the most iconic place that redefined the course of India's history.

The work that Swami Vivekanandaji spearheaded, Swami Chinmayarondaji carried forward with great zeal and vigour.

Having the two masters meet in this most wonderful monument is a moment that we, the Yatri-s of the Chinmaya Amrit Yatra got to witness.

May this great work grow more and more profound.

Swami Anukulandanda
13/04/2026

Chinmaya Yuva Kendra
Youth wing of Chinmaya Mission.

75
years

Youth Alone Can!



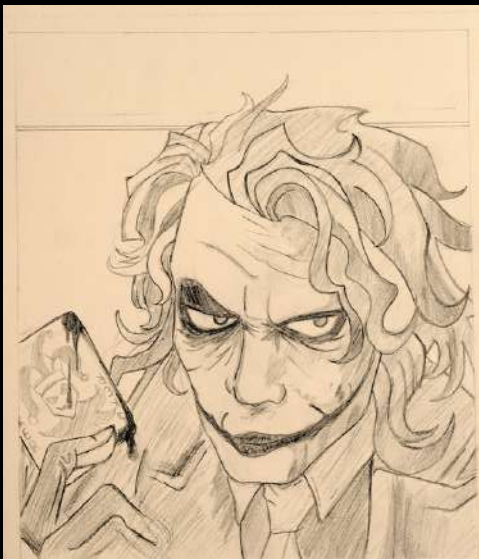
CHINMAYA AMRIT YATRA

Temple on Wheels



CAPTURES





T Muhil - XI 🐦



Ekalavya - IX 🐦



Tarushi Agarwal - XII 🐦



Devanshi Navin- VIII 🐦



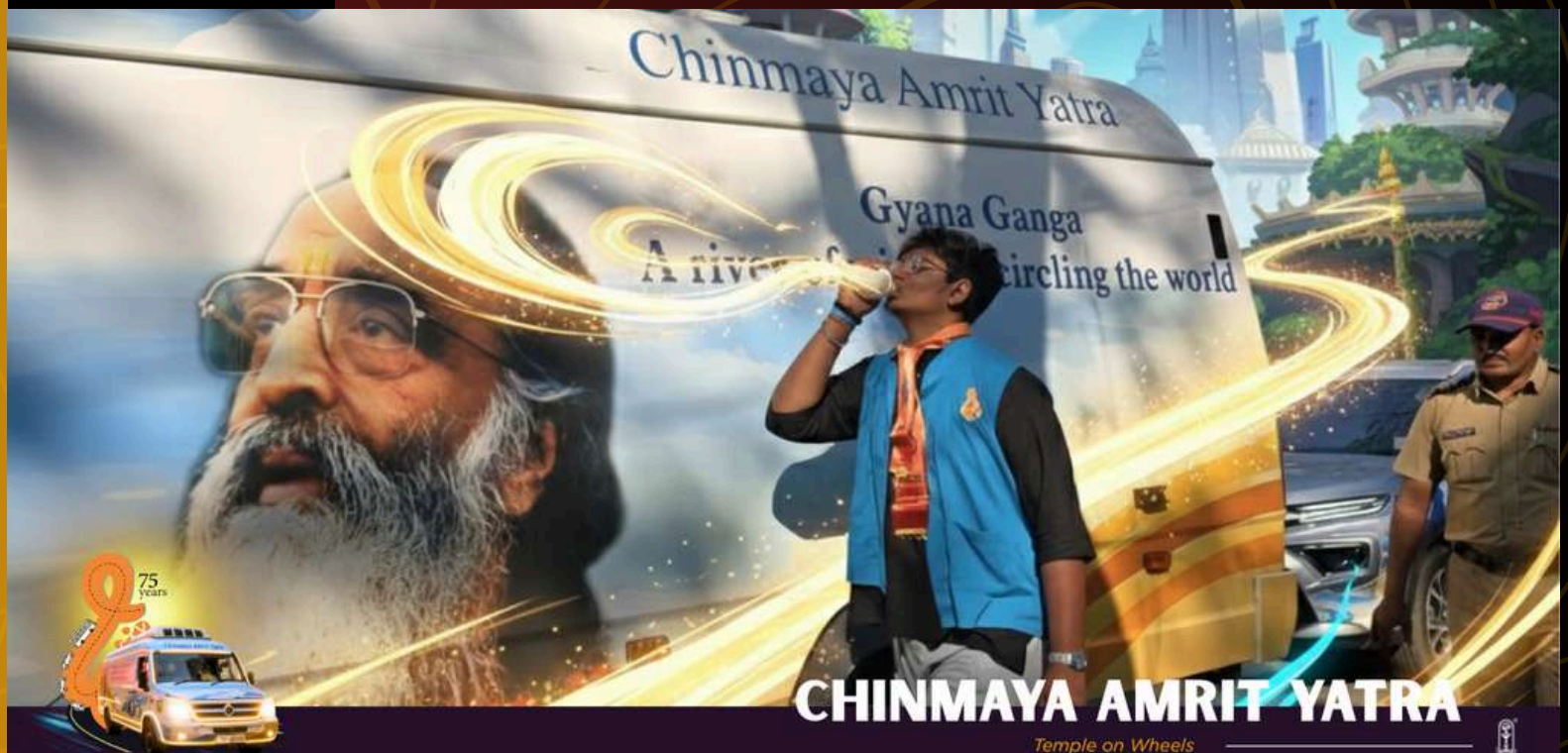
Anushka Modi - XII 🐦



Radha Goyal - XII 🐦

Living in Awareness - Chinmayam | April 2026

This month, we focus on "Decoding Culture." From the lighting of a lamp, to the chanting of a Shloka, every cultural act is a pointer to a deeper truth. We ensure that our culture remains a living, breathing experience that refines our personality (Sanskriti) rather than a repetitive habit.



THE CROSSROADS

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#WisdomOnWheels

As part of Chinmaya Amrit Mahotsav, Chinmaya Mission presents the Chinmaya Amrit Yatra – a 295-day national pilgrimage to honor the legacy of Pujya Gurudev Swami Chinmayananda and carry His message, grace, and presence across the sacred landscape of Bharat.

Beginning at Chinmaya Vibhooti, Pune on 31 December 2025 and culminating at Bharat Mandapam in Delhi on 23 October 2026, the Yatra will journey through the heart of India – awakening souls, uniting communities, and celebrating the timeless relevance of Pujya Gurudev Swami Chinmayananda's vision.



Our gratitude to the CIRS management for giving flight to our initiative.

Chinmaya International Residential School

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The Crossroads follows the standards of American English.